5.PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE FOR STREAMING IT PROCUREMENT:AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOB ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

1.Introduction

The development phase is an important stage in the project because the planned system is converted into a working application. In this project, ServiceNow Flow Designer is used to automate the process of ordering standard laptops for employees. The main aim is to reduce manual work, simplify approval procedures, and improve the efficiency of IT procurement.

2.Requirement Analysis

The first step is to identify the functional requirements of the system. The system must allow employees to submit laptop requests, managers to approve or reject requests, and the procurement team to process approved requests.

The main requirements include:

- Employee details and laptop request information.
- Standard laptop model selection.
- Manager approval functionality.
- Automated email notifications.
- Request status tracking.
- Procurement team notification.

3.ServiceNow Configuration

ServiceNow is configured to support the laptop ordering process. The required tables, forms, fields, and access permissions are prepared based on the project requirements.

The laptop request form may contain the following fields:

- Employee Name

- Employee ID

- Department

- Laptop Model

- Business Justification

- Request Date

- Approval Status

- Request Status

These fields help collect and manage the information required for laptop procurement.

4.Flow Designer Development

Flow Designer is the main automation tool used in this project. A flow is created to manage the laptop ordering process automatically.

The flow includes the following steps:

Step 1: Trigger

The flow starts when an employee submits a new laptop request.

Step 2: Validate Request

The system checks whether the required information has been provided.

Step 3: Manager Approval

An approval request is sent to the employee’s manager. The manager reviews the request and approves or rejects it.

Step 4: Conditional Processing

The flow checks the approval result using conditional logic.

- If the request is approved, the flow continues to procurement processing.

- If the request is rejected, the request status is updated, and the employee is notified.

Step 5: Procurement Notification

When the request is approved, a notification is sent to the IT procurement team to begin processing the laptop order.

Step 6: Status Update

The request status is updated according to the current stage of the process.

Step 7: Employee Notification

The employee receives a notification about the approval decision and the progress of the request.

5.Approval Workflow Implementation

The approval workflow ensures that laptop requests are reviewed before procurement begins. The manager checks the business justification and confirms whether the laptop is required.

The approval process helps prevent unnecessary orders and ensures that requests follow the organization’s procurement policies.

6.Automated Notification Setup

Notifications are configured to keep employees, managers, and procurement staff informed.

The system can send notifications when:

- A new laptop request is submitted.

- Manager approval is required.

- A request is approved or rejected.

- Procurement processing begins.

- The request is completed.

This reduces the need for manual communication and improves transparency.

7.Request Status Management

The system maintains the status of each laptop request. Example statuses include:

- Submitted

- Pending Approval

- Approved

- Rejected

- Processing

- Completed

These statuses help employees and administrators understand the current stage of each request.

8.Testing During Development

After creating the flow, testing is performed to ensure that all actions work correctly.

The following scenarios are tested:

- Submitting a laptop request with valid information.

- Sending the approval request to the correct manager.

- Processing an approved request.

- Handling a rejected request.

- Sending notifications to the correct recipients.

- Updating the request status correctly.

Errors identified during testing are corrected before deployment.

9.Security and Access Control

Access controls are configured to protect request information. Employees should be able to submit and view their own requests, managers should be able to review requests assigned to them, and procurement staff should have the access required to process approved orders.

Appropriate permissions help maintain data security and prevent unauthorized changes.

10.Expected Development Outcome

The development phase produces an automated laptop procurement workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The system reduces repetitive manual tasks, improves approval tracking, provides timely notifications, and helps the IT procurement team process standard laptop requests more efficiently.

Conclusion

The project development phase transforms the requirements into a functional automated system. By configuring ServiceNow forms, approval actions, conditional logic, notifications, and status updates, the project streamlines standard laptop ordering. The completed workflow provides a structured and transparent process for employees, managers, and the IT procurement team.Note: The exact configuration depends on your ServiceNow instance, available tables, and organizational approval rules. The above describes the proposed development; it does not mean the workflow has already been configured or tested.